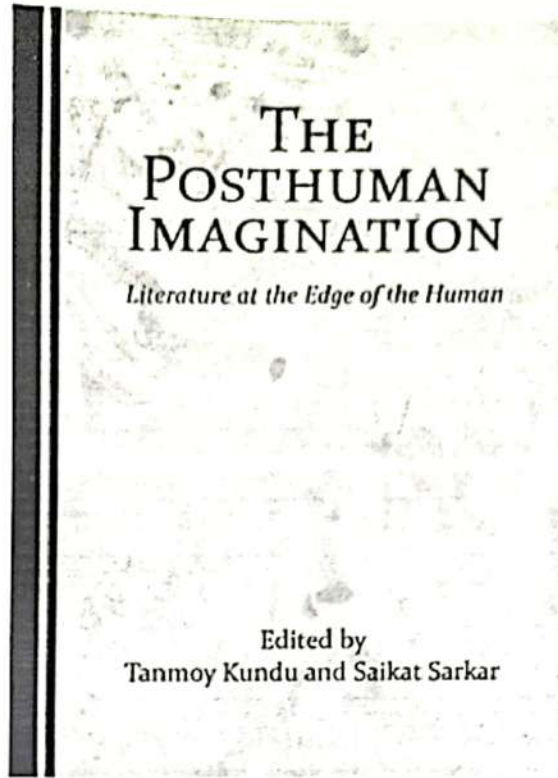




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Snapshots
Self-analyzed
26.05.22

The Posthuman Imagination:

*Literature at the Edge
of the Human*

Edited by

Tanmoy Kundu and Saikat Sarkar

Cambridge
Scholars
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Shravan
26.05.2022

The Posthuman Imagination: Literature at the Edge of the Human

Edited by Tanmoy Kundu and Saikat Sarkar

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Swapan Borga
26.05.22

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Swapna Roy
24.05.2022

MENTAL HEALTH AND CYBERSPACE: EXPLORING THE PSYCHO-SOCIOLOGICAL NEEDS FOR THE NEW MILLENNIUM

SWAPNA ROY

The word 'identity' is a late 16th-century Latin word derived from the Latin 'identitas', which is itself borrowed from the word 'idem', meaning the same. The virtual avatar¹ is, at the same time, *us*, and not *us*, in our real life. Jean Baudrillard, a postmodern cultural critic, in his book *Simulations* (1983), exemplified the virtual world thus: "In fact, it is no longer enveloped by an imaginary, it is no longer real at all. It is hyperreal. The product of an irradiating synthesis of combinatory models in a hyperspace without atmosphere" (127). However, the question is, how does this hyperreal world connect to the branch of psychology? Christian Wolff, first introduced the term 'psychology' as a practice to measure mental phenomena in his book *Psychologia Empirica*.² Cyberpsychology expands its area by means of connecting the virtual spaces, and premises how the rupture of the original in cyberspace creates a pathological situation for our mental health. Henceforth, the binary relationship between man and machine in the field of psychology has also been reasserted. Two opposing views of cyberpsychology in a posthuman culture have thus emerged. On the one hand, in cyberspace, the subject 'liberates' itself through its virtual avatar, and, at the same time, it creates multiple identities through the rhizomatic structure of networked information. Cyberpsychology, as a discipline, focuses on the essential traits of the human mind triggered by (un)fulfilled desire and need.

"I'll be your mirror"; Jean Baudrillard, in *Xerox and Infinity* (1983), wrote:

¹ The word is derived from Sanskrit word meaning 'descent' and in the 18th century it appeared in English referring to the incarnation of deity on the earth. In the virtual world, it refers to an embodied projection controlled by a computer.

² Wolff, Christian. 1738. *Psychologia Empirica Editio Nova*. Francofurti: Renger, 1738.

Swapna Roy
26.05.2022

Girish Karnad was a well known playwright, theatre and film director, actor and above all a nationalist thinker. His plays mark the contemporary situations at the time of the classical Indian drama. His fusion of the classical and the modern make them unique. This book contains critical articles on various aspects of the plays of Girish Karnad. They explore the chosen and dramatic text development of Indian English drama and attempt to place Karnad in this tradition. Since the plays of Girish Karnad make an important part of any academic discussion on Indian English Literature and Indian drama this book will be useful for the scholars of literature and drama besides the lovers of Girish Karnad.



Dr. Hemeetra Singh Chandalla is a Professor of English at Jangarai Rajasthani University (Jaipur). He has eighteen books and about thirty five research papers to his credit. Three collections of his poems namely *Safer Se Puri* (1995), *Saf Swarna Mahal* and *Sandhya* (1998) and *Main Tume Bula Karun* (2014) have been published. His major books in addition to poetry are: *Script to Screen: The Progressive Vision of Akhila Arundhati* (2014), *Tribal Literature, Culture and Knowledge Systems* (2018), *Killing Gandhi* (2020) and *The Power of Pen* (2021). He has been awarded prestigious *Chandra Dev Sharma Award* by Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi (1985), *Maharaja Raj Singh Award* (1985), *Poetry Society (India) Writing Award* (2005), *Dr. Rajendra Prasad Bhattacharya Award* of Kumar Lavande Academic Excellence Award (2016) and *Kalashikar Central University of Haryana* for two years from Feb. 2012 to Feb. 2014. He has HOD English, Dean Faculty of Social Sciences and Humanities and Officiating Vice Chancellor. Besides his doctorate in English he has a master's degree (Gold Medal) in Journalism and Mass Communication and a PG Diploma in Translation from IGNOU. He has a PG certificate in Teaching English from CIEET, Hyderabad, a Culture Studies and a PG Diploma in Translation from IGNOU. He was appointed as the President's Nominee in the Court of Governors Hindu India for a term of three years. Prof. Chandalla has worked on *Safer Se Puri* in pursuance of his academic interest.



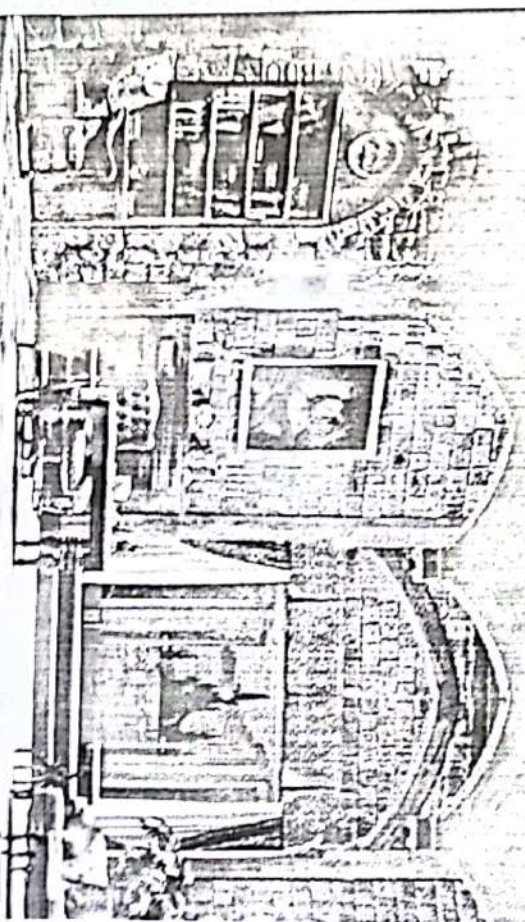
Dr. Abrar Ahmed, Assistant Professor, Pooja University, Uttar Pradesh, is an Alumnus of St. Paul's College, Jaipur. He has eleven years teaching experience. He teaches U.G. and P.G. courses and three decades research work under his supervision. His areas of interest in teaching include English Language and Literature Teaching, Composition, and ESP. He has co-authored two books based on Grammar and Communication. He has participated in three Faculty Development Programme and presented 12 papers and published 17 in National/International conferences and workshops. To his credit, he has a Master's degree in English Literature, B.Ed., M.Phil (L.T.) (Gold Medalist) and Ph.D. (L.T.).

H.S. Chandalla
Abrar Ahmed

Dramatizing the Truth
THE PLAYS OF GIRISH KARNAD

Dramatizing the Truth THE PLAYS OF GIRISH KARNAD

H.S. Chandalla • Abrar Ahmed



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Swapna Roy
28/08/2021

Myths, Folk Elements and Unconscious: Contextualising Girish Karnad's *Naga-mandala*

Swapna Roy

Introduction

Myth, when analyzed linguistically and semiotically, brings forth its multi-layers of meanings and allows in its coded range the generation of each era to writ large a new message which is to be re-coded in times to come. Thus, the myth always remains an ever-fresh text for the resolution and the dissolution of conflict in literature. The recondite meaning in the structure of myth takes an addition, deduction, and concession of incorporating the modes of conflict and tension in the form of literary works. The linguistic properties and the symbolic meanings inherent in it make the reader think of the incredible range of human thoughts and culture. Myth is one of the principal roots of drama. It embodies knowledge in the form of an image that is more potent than a statement. Karnad uses myth as an archetype to express meaning for contemporary life. For him, myths are part of the collective consciousness of the people. The properties of oral tradition and folkloristic lineaments embedded in the structure of the play pertinently deals with the situational needs(s) and the contextual realities, standing nearer to the advantages of common interest and the solipsistic aspects of the social commune and figural forms of language. The phonic and morphic application to language can easily be seen in the following examples:

Swapna Roy
26/10/2022